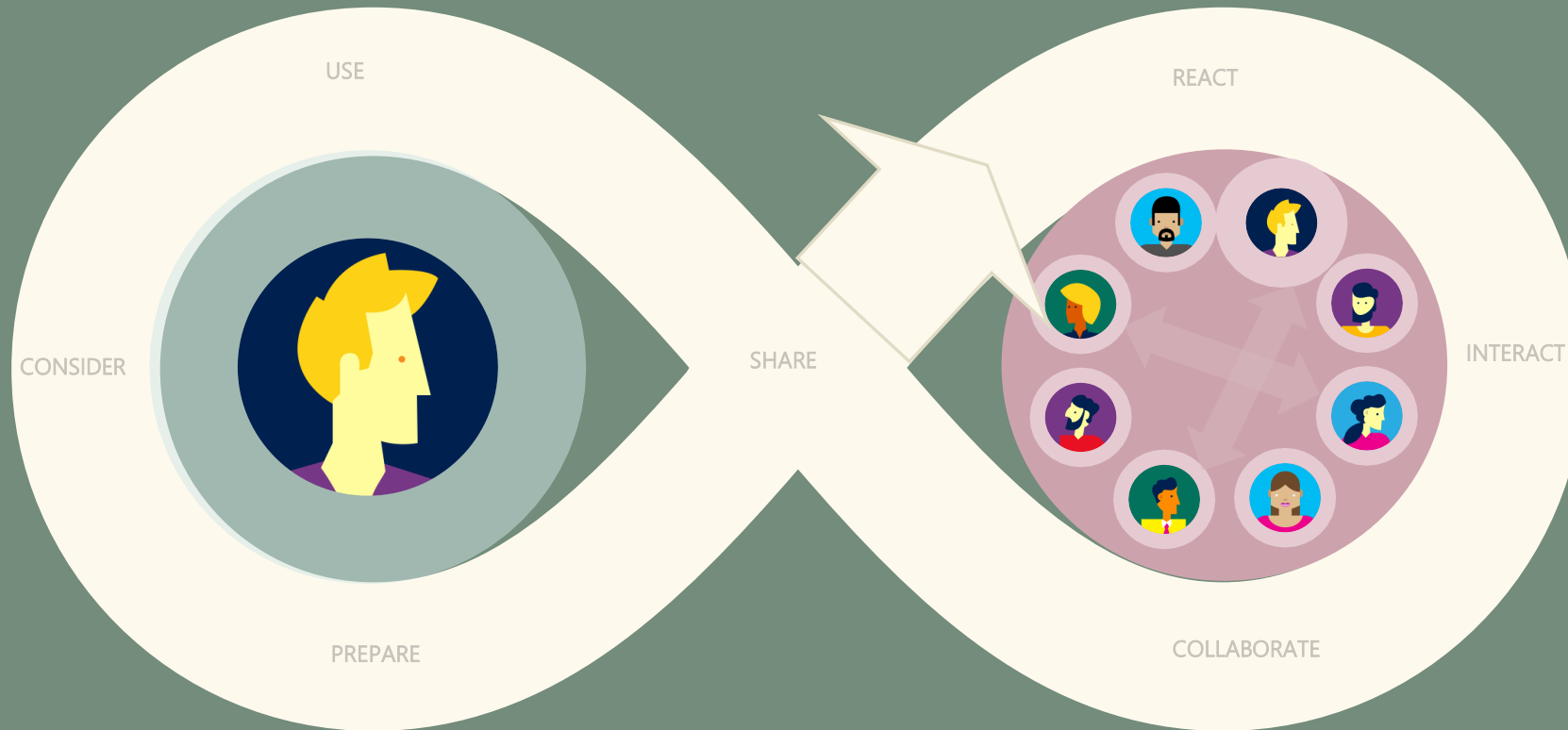


From Solo AI to Social AI

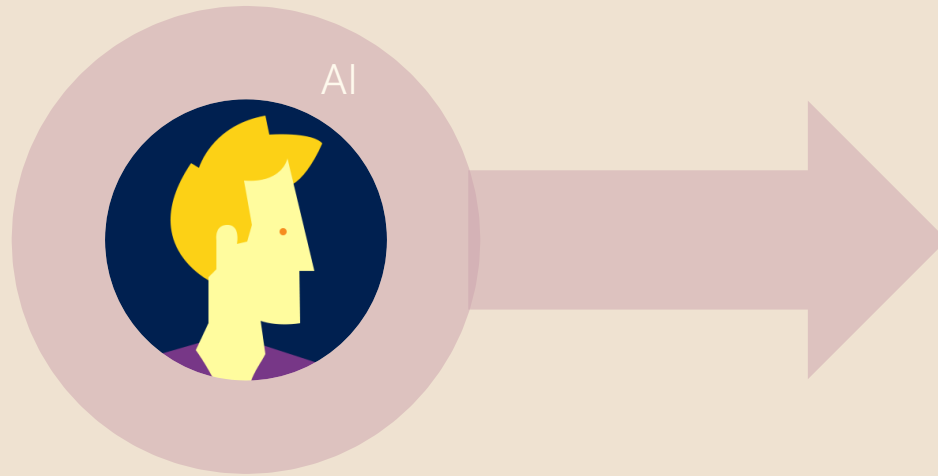
Designing Copilot For Social Spread & Engagement



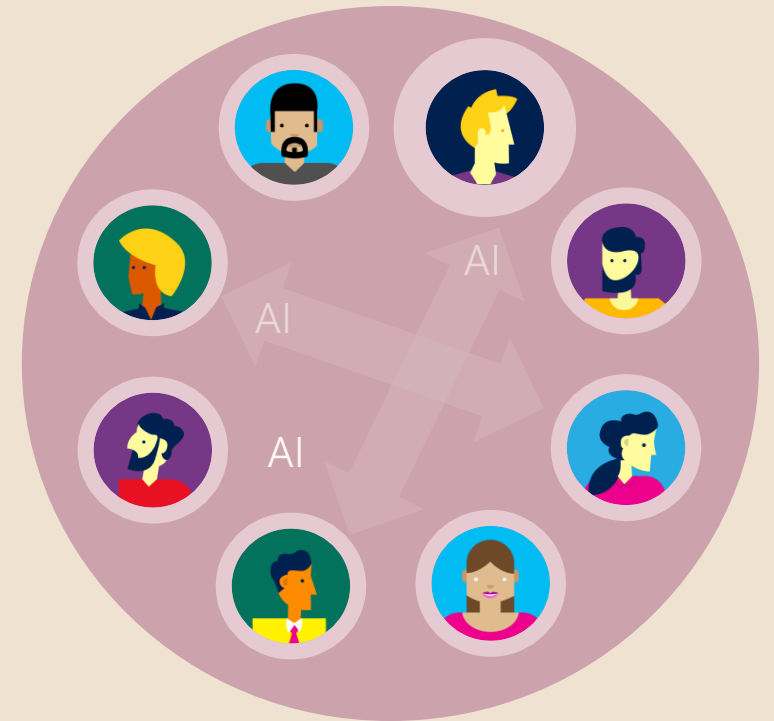
MAI Discovery Research

Ming-Li Chai & Rachele Benjamin
5-8-2026

The next frontier



SOLO
use of AI



SOCIAL
use of AI

Why should MAI care?

[Growth]

Sharing is a growth and virality engine

[Engagement]

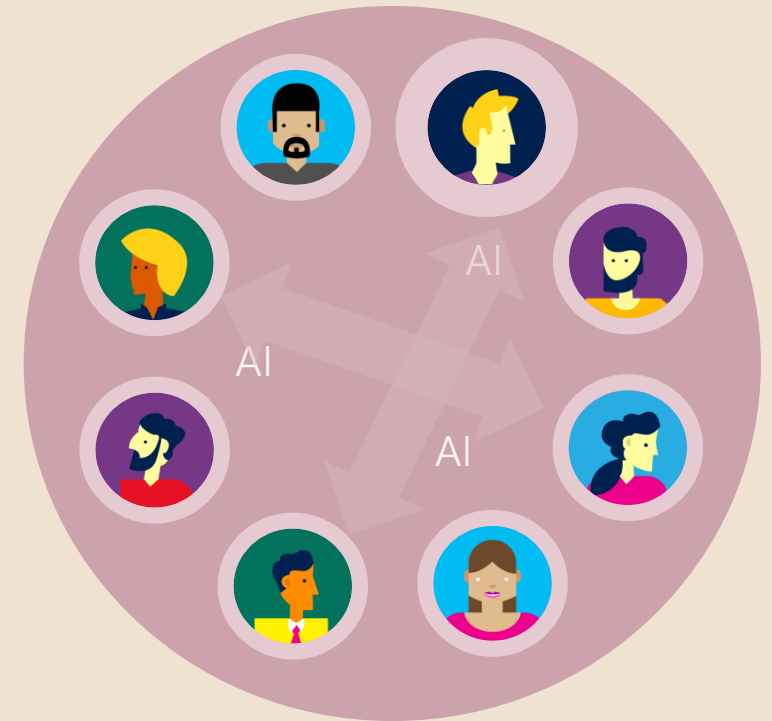
Social use deepens solo engagement

[Experience Innovation]

New use cases and high value vertical scenarios

[Brand]

Opportunity to pre-empt “social AI” in life and work



SOCIAL AI

Discovery questions:



1 → Many

How does AI use spread form one to many?



Many → Better

How might AI help groups become better together?

Methodologies

HEAT SENSING: Quant

Surfacing the greatest AI “sharing” and “joint-use” opportunities across 7 groupsonas (family, friends, partners, special interest groups, classroom, project teams, service providers)

- 30 minute UserTesting and Qualtrics Panels survey
- 1045 participants (465 US, 550 Japan)
- AI users & digital group members with medium AI fluency (M = 3.43)

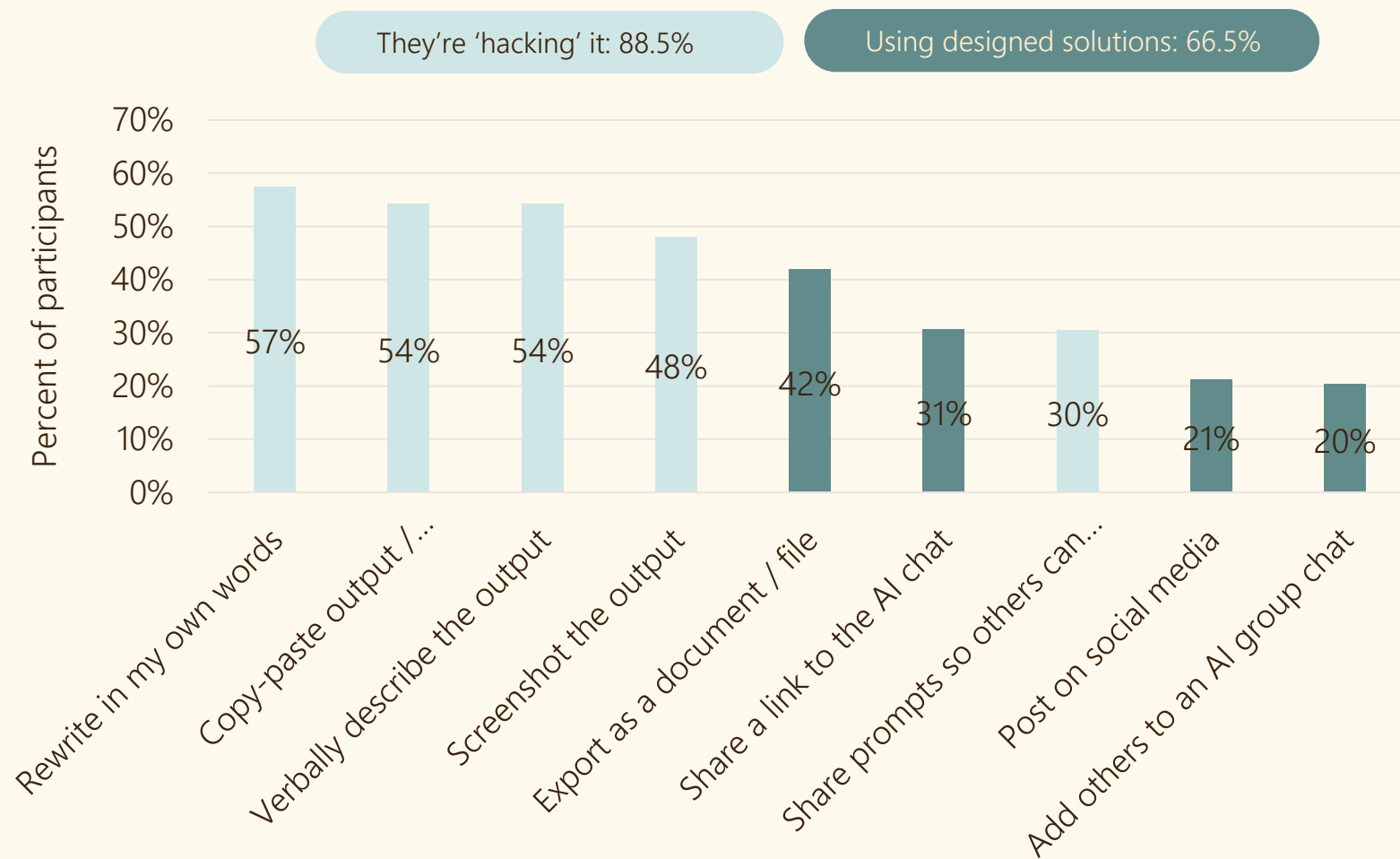
DEPTH & DISCOVERY : Qual

Yielding in-depth insights about social AI momentum, hesitations and high-value scenarios

Co-designing 0-1 solutions across 7 groupsonas

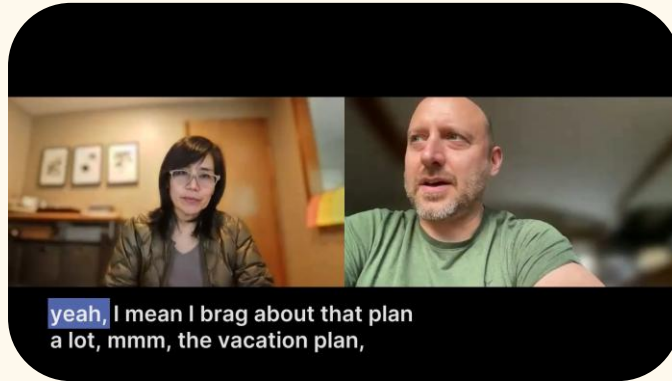
- 75-minute Dscout and UserTesting interviews
- 20 participants (US sample)
- AI users & digital group members, medium-high AI fluency

AI is already social



N = 1045

AI Sharing : User stories



Chris plans a road trip to Montana

Social AI behavior: Solo search → shares options

Momentum: High excitement + validation

Hesitation: Limited group input



Cody creates a liquidity report

Social AI behavior: Solo research and PPT creation → seeks targeted feedback

Momentum: AI helps build the story arc

Hesitation: Loss of his own voice



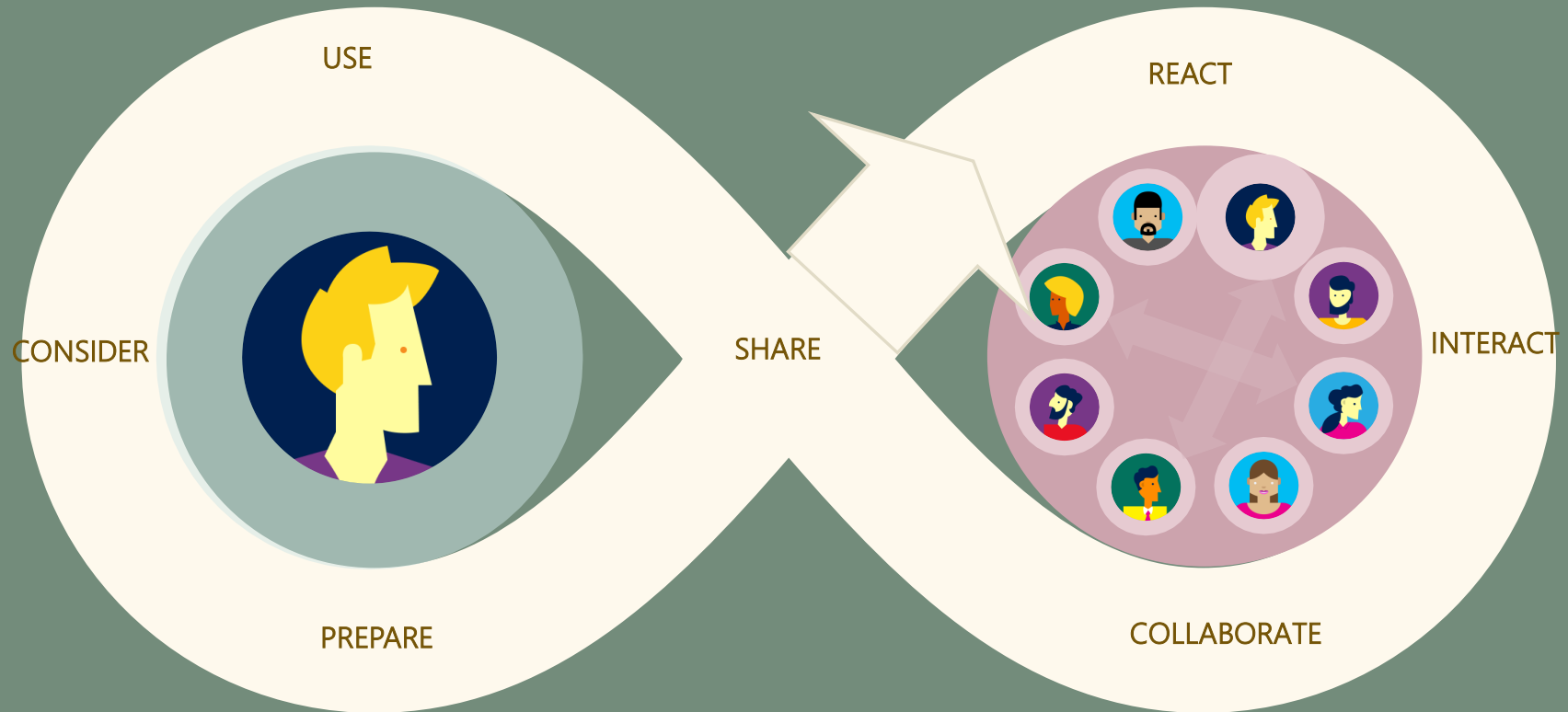
Megan gets lab results back

Social AI behavior: Solo use → shares findings across different audiences

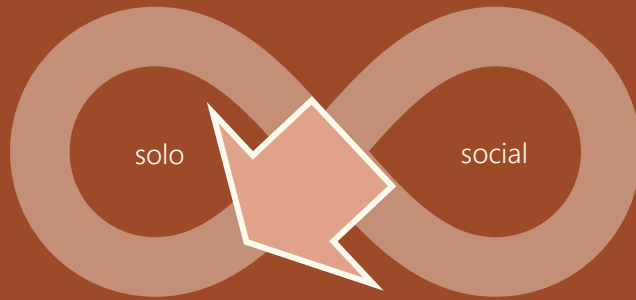
Momentum: AI reduces uncertainty

Hesitation: resistance from healthcare team, family stress

Solo → Social AI Diffusion Loop



Hesitation



🤖 Social Discomfort

Fear of judgment, stigma of using AI, not wanting to seem lazy or incompetent

🔑 Tool Friction

No easy way to share — copy-pasting, screenshotting, switching between apps

🗣️ Inauthenticity

AI output doesn't sound like "me" — sharing it feels dishonest or impersonal

🗨️ Lack of Response

Sharing into a void — no reaction, no engagement, effort feels wasted

⚡ Difficult Social Discourse

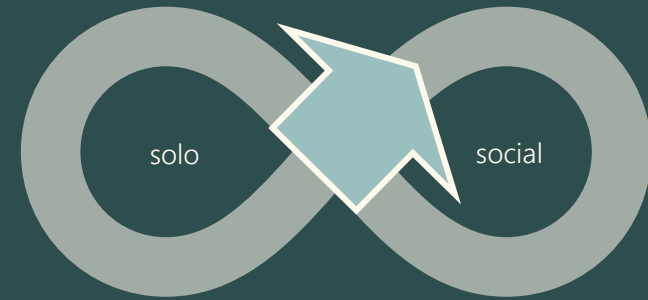
Debates devolve, opinions clash, AI adds complexity instead of clarity

📅 Lack of Commitment

Others won't follow through — plans die, no accountability, coordination tax

Hesitation
Social Judgment

Momentum



🌟 Excitement of Discovery

Finding something genuinely useful or surprising — the urge to say "look at this!"

💛 Benefit to Self & Others

Sharing creates value for both sides — saves time, solves problems, builds connection

✂️ Ease of Curation

When it's easy to reshape AI output into something personal and shareable

💬 Positive Reaction

Getting engagement, appreciation, or follow-up — social validation of sharing

🎯 Mutual Interest

Shared context makes sharing natural — couples, hobby groups, friend squads

🏆 Commitment to Cooperation

When both parties invest — joint projects, shared goals, persistent accountability

Momentum
Positive Reaction

Trust in solo is a pre-condition to trust in social

Persistent hold-backs:

- Privacy [49%],
- Accuracy [42%]

[security need]

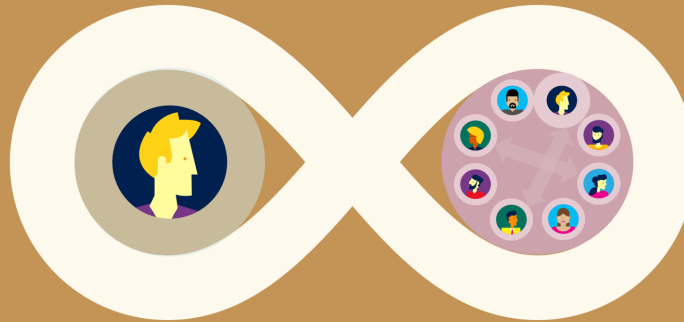
"Is my information protected?"

[accuracy need]

"Can I trust this output?"

[sources, balanced perspectives]

"Is this information unbiased?"



Emergent hold-backs:

- Group comfort [30%],
- Appearing dependent on AI [30%]

[circles of sharing & permissions]

"Will AI tell everyone my secrets?"

[accurate, tone]

"What will others think of my AI use?"

[authentic voice]

"Will AI represent me poorly?"

[neutral third party]

"Will the group accept the AI?"

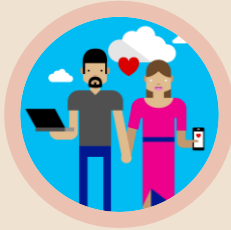
[group-level controls]

"Will they feel comfortable with AI?"

[moderating voice]

"Will AI protect us?"

The social context : 7 “groupsonas”



PARTNERS



FRIENDS



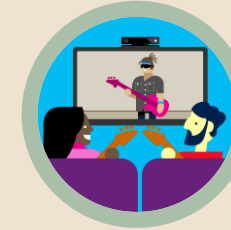
FAMILY



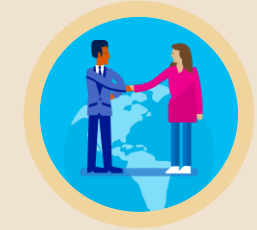
TEAM



CLASS



SHARED INTEREST



B to C

Durable

Temporary

Transactional

Trust

Trusting
(M = 3.34/4)

Trusting
(M = 3.2/4)

Trusting
(M = 3.4/4)

Less trusting
(M = 2.4/4)

Less trusting
(M = 2.7/4)

Less trusting
(M = 2.8/4)

Less trusting
(M = 2.7/4)

Closeness

Close
(M = 3.5/4)

Close
(M = 3.3/4)

Close
(M = 3.7/4)

Less close
(M = 2.6/4)

Less close
(M = 2.7/4)

Less close
(M = 2.9/4)

Not close
(M = 2/4)

Power dynamic

Somewhat equal
(M = 2.4/4)

Equal
(M = 3.2/4)

Somewhat equal
(M = 2.5/4)

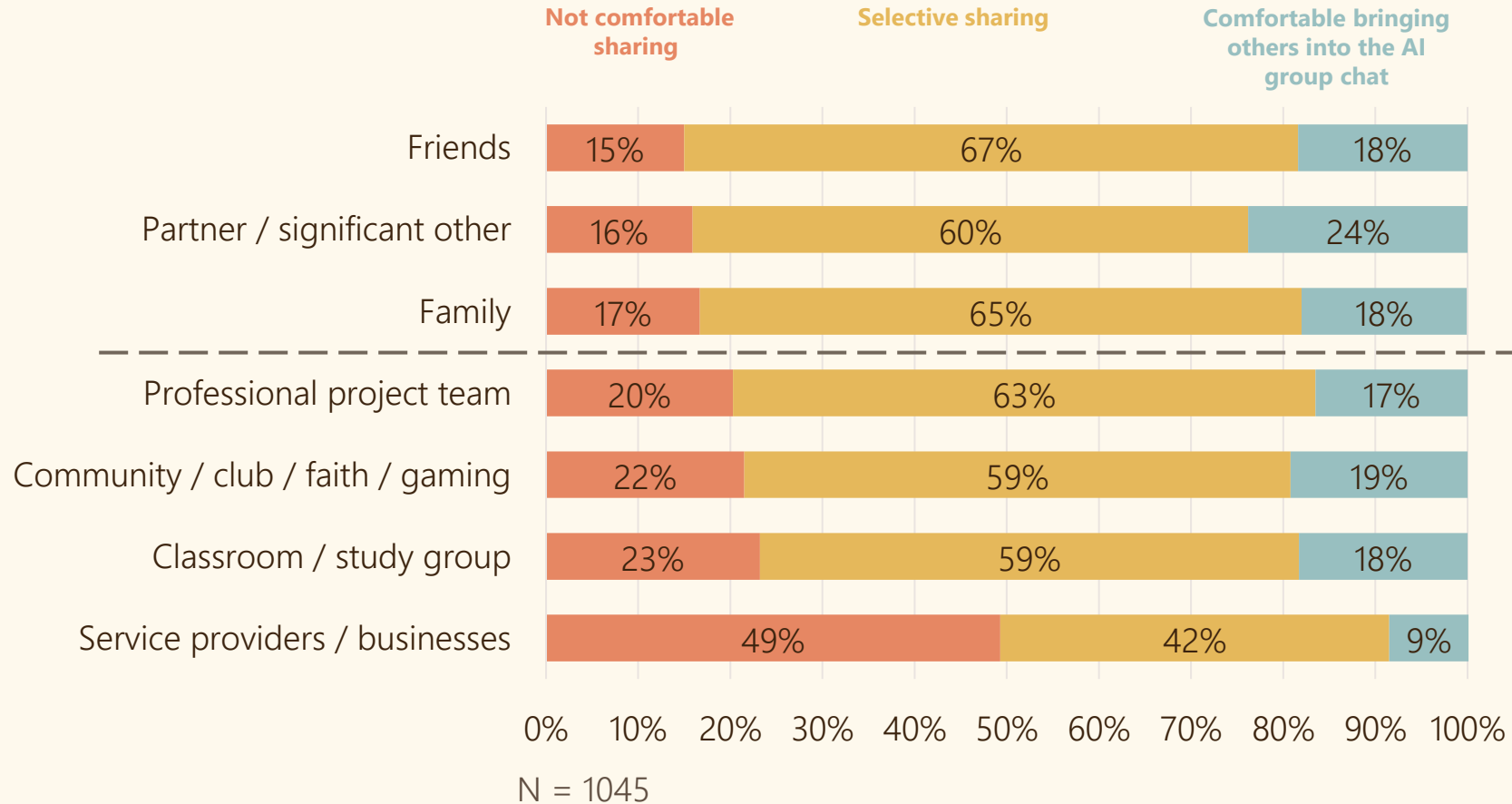
Somewhat equal
(M = 2.4/4)

Somewhat equal
(M = 2.7/4)

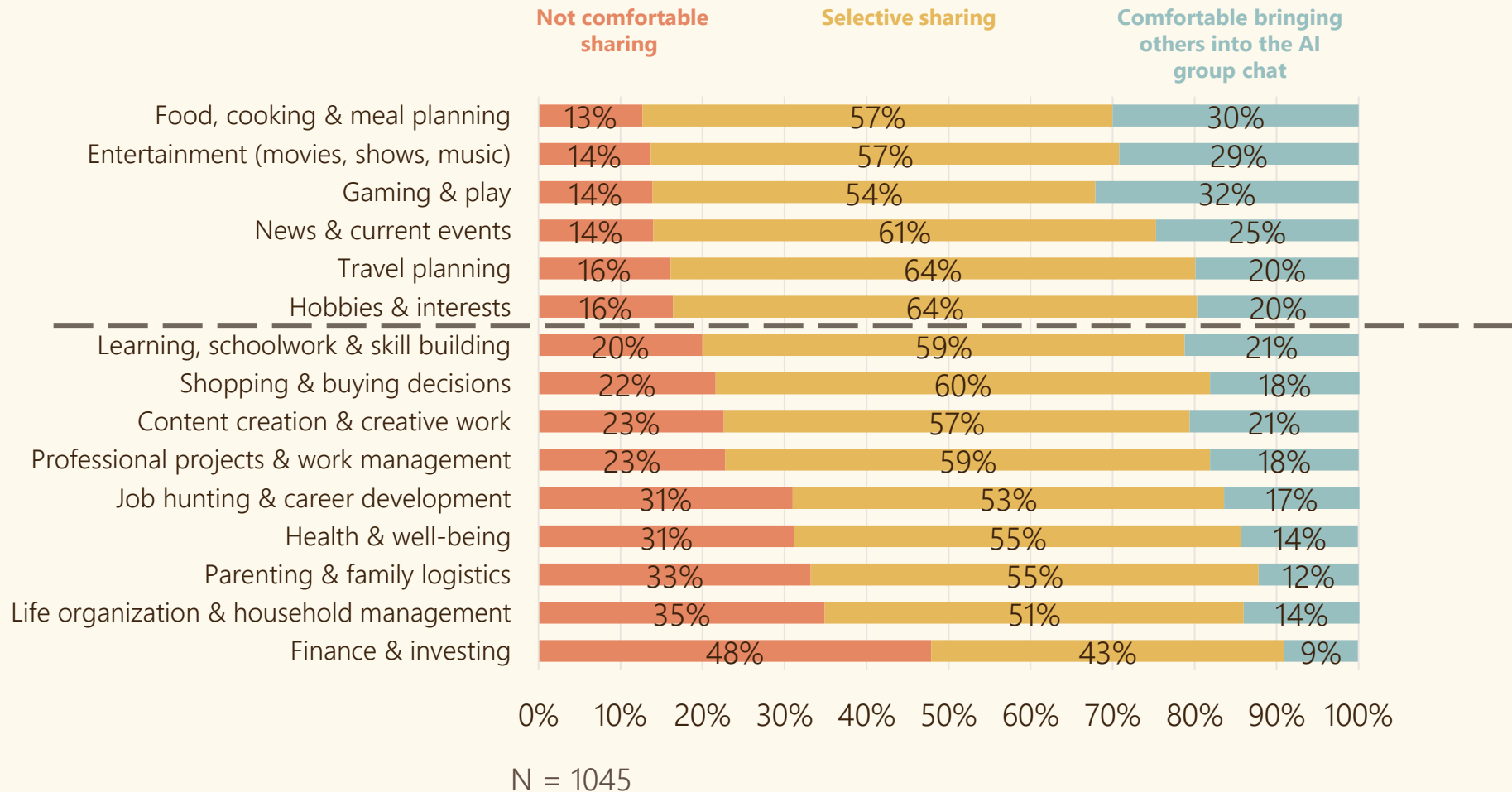
Equal
(M = 2.8/4)

Somewhat equal
(M = 2.6/4)

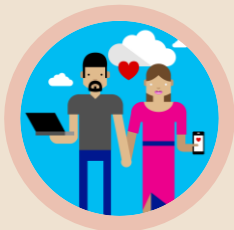
Closer ties, more comfort for social AI



Lighter topics, more comfort for social AI



Top 3 Social AI Topics by Groupsona



PARTNERS



FRIENDS



FAMILY



TEAM



CLASS



SHARED INTEREST



B to C

Travel Planning



Productivity & Projects



Food & Meal Planning



News & Current Events



Learning & Skills



Signature scenarios

Garden project
Family trip
Real estate

Tarvel
Dinner out
Sports chat

Road trip
Health
Meal Plan

Work Presentation
Volunteer crew

Study group
Sport team

Wine club
Sports betting

Healthcare
Business PR
Travel service

Social AI : Value-based Experience Opportunities

Help Me
**Express & Influence
with Confidence**



Share Better

- Controlled Curation
- Social-able Artifact
- Authentic Voice
- Ubiquitous Share

Help Me
**Tune In to What's
Important**



Sense Better

- TL;DR
- Theme Buckets
- Timely AMA
- Proactive Discovery

Help Us
**Appreciate Everyone's
Perspective**



Interact Better

- Loop You In
- Tiered Participation
- Async Brainstorm
- Level-headed 3rd Party

Help Us
**Accomplish a Shared
Outcome**



Collaborate Better

- Shared Idea Space
- Group Coordination
- Family PM
- Joint POV



Share Better:

Help me express and influence with confidence

Sharing today means screenshots, copy-paste, and verbal retelling, losing context, tone, or interactivity.

Controlled Curation

Select, omit, and polish before sharing, not all-or-nothing chat dumps.

"You just screenshotted this. Would you like a summary? Let me curate it — maybe I don't want that part included."
--- Kerri



KERRI • PREGNANCY HEALTH SCORE

"Share Better → Loop In → Jump In"

Kenna's AI chat is too long and includes embarrassing questions. AI offers a curated summary — she selects/omits parts, exports to Snapchat. Kerri joins via invite link with a catch-up summary.

Social-able Artifact

Transform AI chat into expressive, easy-to-consume media or visual summaries.

"A 20-second video — I have friends with a very short attention span. You curate it, give it a tone, and AI produces it."
— Iridian



IRIDIAN • SKINCARE RESEARCH FOR FRIENDS

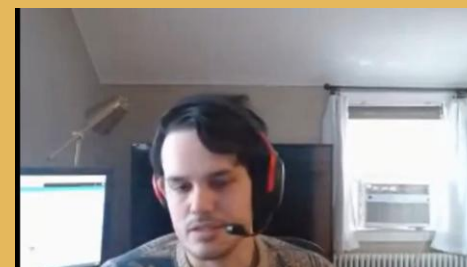
TikTok-Style Explainer Clip

Micro-needling research becomes a 20-second animated video in modern slang. A cartoon pen explains the procedure. Shareable across platforms — each recipient gets the format that fits.

Authentic Voice

Output that sounds like you. Your tone, emphasis, and thinking made visible.

"You can't lose the thought process aspect. You have to capture and portray it." — Cody



CODY • AI-ASSISTED WORK DECKS

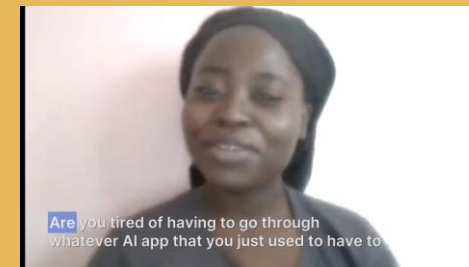
"80% Done" — Thought Process Visible

Cody iterates until 80% done — polished enough to react to. AI captures where he had reservations and where he committed, then routes to the right expert.

Ubiquitous Share

A floating widget across every app. Tap, select, preview, send. No app-switching.

"A little AI logo that follows you wherever you are. Not specific to Gemini or ChatGPT. It works for all of them."
— Jeannette



JEANNETTE • SHARING STUDY BREAKTHROUGHS

Floating Share Widget

On FaceTime, Jeannette wants to share an AI breakthrough instantly. A floating widget lets her select the relevant snippet, preview, and send — works across all AI apps.



Sense Better:

Help me tune in to what's important

Groups drown in linear, unsortable, unsearchable messages. The #1 pain isn't missing AI, it's information chaos.

TL;DR

Quick summaries when you return : decisions made, input needed. 30 seconds to same page.

"If my husband takes three days to log in, it pulls an automatic summary of what happened." — Lisa



LISA · PANTRY REMODEL PROJECT

Async Catch-Up

Lisa's husband logs in **3 days later**. AI: "Lisa narrowed contractors to two. Budget is \$X. She's waiting on your countertop input." Caught up in 30 seconds.

Theme Buckets

Conversations auto-sorted into meaningful buckets, searchable by meaning, not keywords.

"Organize into buckets — run concept, pass concept. A library you can easily reference." — Tony



TONY · 35-PERSON COACHING STAFF CHAT

Smart Coaching Knowledge Hub

AI **auto-sorts into buckets: run concept, pass concept** — by play type, situation, personnel. Any coach searches by meaning: "What did we say about the red zone?"

Timely AMA

Real-time answers when the window is minutes, not hours. AI as live analyst cutting through noise.

"Sports betting is very time sensitive. Down to the minutes. Use AI to help us w decision making" - Paul



PAUL · SPORTS BETTING FRIENDS · REAL-TIME ODDS

Time-Sensitive "Jump In"

Odds shift by the minute. AI surfaces **real-time analysis across multiple sites** visible to all. If no response, Paul can **retract the share** and the tip expires.

Proactive Discovery

AI surfaces timely and serendipitous things you'd miss: events, opportunities, connections.

"None of us knew about that event. It was written small in their booklet. AI announced it." - Carol



CAROL · SATURDAY CREW · GROUP OUTINGS

Proactive Event Discovery

AI notifies Carol: **"Since you volunteer for Girl Scouts, did you know about this camping event?"** She shares to the group. AI generates a signup sheet and nudges non-responders.



Interact Better:

Help us appreciate everyone's perspective

Loud voices dominate, quiet ones disappear, and conflicts get swept under the rug.

Loop You In

Loop others into a near-final plan so they can react, refine, or approve.

"Hey I think it got it down to a final plan. Look these over. Anything you want to change?" - Cassandra



CASSANDRA · MARRIED COUPLE TRIP PLANNING

Loop You In

Cassandra whittles down the trip plan solo, then alerts her husband: **"Look these over."** He can add prompts for what he wants to change — in his own words, so she doesn't misinterpret.

Tiered Participation

Progressive tiers : lurk, vote, suggest, assert. Quiet voices counted, loud ones balanced.

"Tune-in is like lurking. Chime-in is an upvote or downvote. Jump in is invested. Opt-in is to confirm." - Johnathan



JOHNATHAN · 30-PERSON EXTENDED FAMILY

Progressive Engagement Tiers

AI generates 3 options. Five tiers: **Tune in → Chime in → Weigh in → Jump in → Opt-in**. Time-boxed phases. Diverse budgets respected.

Async Brainstorm

Bounce ideas off each other and the bot with compare-contrast of perspectives.

"Two people bouncing ideas off each other, multiple perspectives, instantly we hey a compare-contrast." — Terry



CRAFTYBEAR · GARDEN PLANNING WITH BOYFRIEND

Async Idea Drop + Compare-Contrast

Either person drops an idea anytime. AI analyzes it, compares it to the other's input, and has it ready **whenever the other person's ready to have their conversation**. No 37-message scroll required.

Level-headed 3rd Party

AI stays calm when you can't. Re-articulates positions, provides private + joint solutions.

"Sometimes an outside voice, like a therapist. Using this as a moderator tool is going to give you a level-headed perspective." — Cassandra



CASSANDRA · MARRIED COUPLE - SENSITIVE

DISAGREEMENTS

AI as a Relationship Mediator

Both enter perspectives. AI confirms: "Is this what you're trying to say?" Then **re-articulates in de-escalated language**. Private solutions AND joint summary. Adjustable filter levels.



Collaborate Better:

Help us accomplish a shared outcome

One person bears the coordination burden while others disengage. Group projects scatter across apps and AI chats. There's no persistent "brain."

Shared Idea Space

A collaborative brain-dump space where both people's ideas are captured, compared, and remembered across sessions.

"We both can be very forgetful, so having the outlet, a collaborative thing to brain-dump and the bot respond to us."

— Terri



CRAFTYBEAR - GARDEN PLANNING WITH BOYFRIEND

Persistent Memory Across Seasons

Either person drops an idea anytime — AI captures it, responds, compares to the other's input. **"Two seasons ago you tried X, don't suggest it again."** The project has a brain that never forgets.

Group Coordination

AI as event coordinator — maps out decision trees, collects everyone's inputs, builds itineraries with links and costs.

"If there's anything I hate doing it's coordinating. Map out decision matrix and guide through the process with a lot of people's inputs" — Chris



CHRIS - 5-FRIEND FLORIDA WEDDING TRIP

AI Travel Agent for the Group

Chris sends a link: **"Get in there, put in whatever food you're interested in, whatever activities."** AI considers weather, budget, constraints — builds an itinerary with estimated costs and individual booking links.

Family PM

Shared AI on the fridge — voice-activated, step-by-step guidance, with memory and task automation for the whole household.

"Any family project. Everyone can see it. How-to steps, with memory and task automation." — Paul



PAUL - MULTI-GENERATIONAL HOUSEHOLD

Household Manager on the Smart Fridge

Voice-activated — anyone walks up and talks. No app barrier for older family members. AI tracks decisions (shingle color vote), notifies everyone, **maps out steps: mortgage first, then realtor, then inspector.**

Joint POV

AI weaves multiple perspectives into one cohesive output. Each role contributes expertise.

"It gets everybody's perspective and generate one cohesive presentation."
— Iridian



IRIDIAN - COMMUNITY HEALTH TEAM

Cohesive Multi-Perspective Presentation

Nurses, community health workers, insurance staff — each sees the issue differently. AI **synthesizes all perspectives into one unified deck** without losing nuance.

Social AI : Value-based Experience Opportunities

Help Me
**Express & Influence
with Confidence**



Share Better

- Controlled Curation
- Social-able Artifact
- Authentic Voice
- Ubiquitous Share

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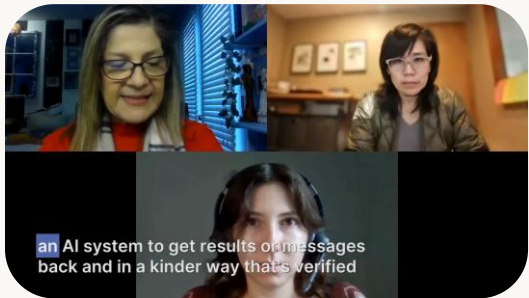
Help Us
**Accomplish a Shared
Outcome**



Collaborate Better

- Shared Idea Space
- Group Coordination
- Family PM
- Joint POV

3 Future scenario demos



NEW SCENARIOS



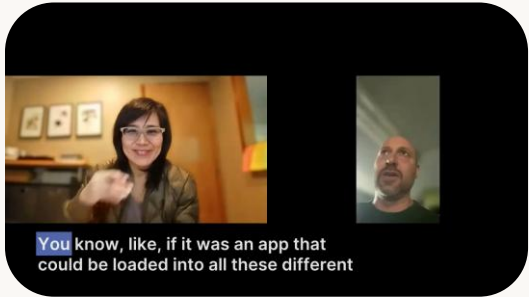
SCENARIO 1 · HEALTH & FAMILY

Megan: Health Results, Shared Peace of Mind

Megan manages a chronic condition and dreads the anxiety of waiting for test results — and the harder task of telling her mom. A doctor-approved AI artifact gives her instant clarity and lets her curate what to share, translated to Spanish, so peace of mind trickles down to her family.



7 scenes · Inspired by [Meghan](#) [Kerri](#) [Paul](#) [Spencer](#) [Iridian](#) [Carol](#)



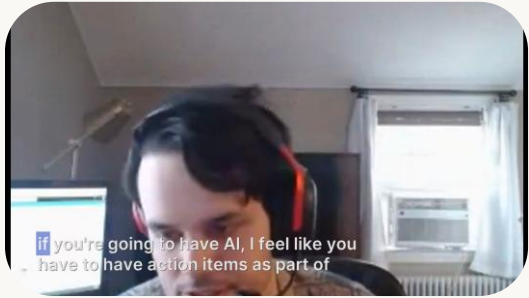
SCENARIO 2 · TRAVEL & FAMILY

Chris: Road Trip to Montana

A friend's wedding sparks a family road trip. Chris starts planning solo in Copilot, then opens it up — wife weighs in, kids pick activities, buddies vote on meetup spots. The itinerary becomes a living artifact that adapts on the road and turns into a keepsake after.



7 scenes · Inspired by [Chris](#) [Cassandra](#) [Craftybear](#) [Noelle](#) [Lisa](#) [Johnathan](#)



SCENARIO 3 · WORK & COLLABORATION

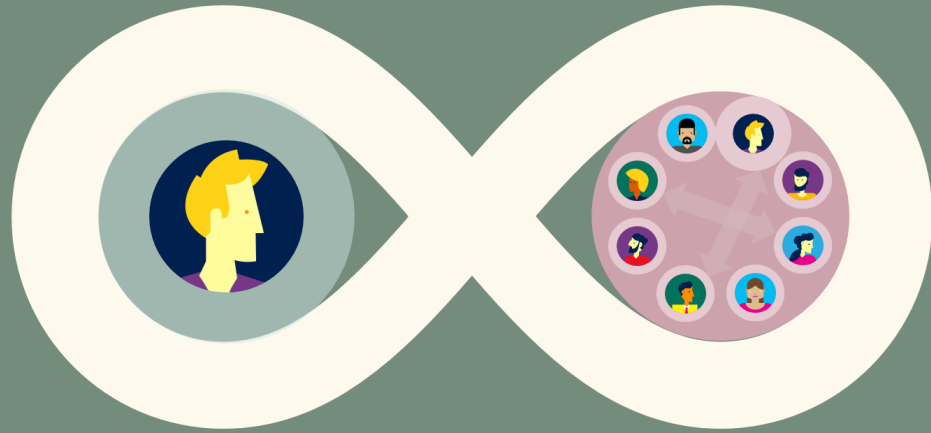
Cody: The 80% Deck

Cody builds a competitive analysis with Copilot and gets it to 80% — the point where he needs a colleague's expertise. Instead of dumping a 40-slide deck, AI shows his thinking and flags exactly where input is needed. Async feedback merges into a final artifact that sounds like him.



6 scenes · Inspired by [Cody](#) [Chris F.](#) [Charnita](#) [Ari](#) [Tony](#) [Jeannette](#)

The present, and the future, of AI is Social



[Growth]

Design sharing as a first-class experience, not a workaround

[Engagement]

Build for the full loop of solo → social engagement journey

[Experience]

Focus on high-value scenarios where people naturally involve others

[Brand]

Lead in defining what 'Social AI' means in both life and work